

Smart SoHo

We pick 10 Google Chrome extensions that are guaranteed to make your work life easier

Industry connect

Nick FitzGerald, Senior Research Fellow, ESET, gives us insights into the current cybersecurity landscape

Careers in VR&AR

If you dream of creating another world for yourself, this might be the best time to make it a reality

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Let's face it, reality is boring. And sometimes, we do feel the need to transcend to an alternate reality, don't we? To leave our schools, colleges and work behind and dive into a completely different world with its own rules. Well, that's no longer a farfetched dream. For the last few years, Virtual Reality and Augmented Reality technology has become much more than just a concept in the labs. Chew on these facts: the HTC Vive started shipping in April, Steam has a dedicated VR section on its store, the Lenovo Phab 2 Pro is built with AR capabilities, Xiaomi launched its own Google Cardboard inspired headset and there are many Indian VR startups who are doing brilliant work in VR and AR at a national and

international level. Seems more like a mainstream medium now, doesn't it?

On that note, it is also evident that VR and AR development are serious career choices right now, with the technology just beginning to grow in our country. And as with any emerging field, there is a dearth of information regarding how exactly should one approach this. Like any other field, this does require a specific skillset, has a specific demand and knowing all of this will only increase one's chances of actually making it big in this industry.

The Roleplay

Aspiring to become a VR or AR developer is commendable, but not enough to even get started down that road. Remember, when some of us as kids used to say that we want to become scientists? We were never specific. It was always just scientists,

not chemists, physicists, biologist etc. This is not that different, except for the fact that this decision for VR and AR needs to be taken from the get go.

Why is it so? Because this field consists of work that is extremely diverse, ranging from story creation to audio expertise to graphics and 3D design and even more. We are over that phase where work in VR and AR solely required technological expertise. Now a fair share of creativity is also involved. With the rise of these technologies more as experiential mediums, students can choose from both technical roles that involve programming, hardware, algorithms and game development, as well as non-technical roles in the field of business, management, marketing and operations.

Chandan Singh, VR Head, Smart-VizX (a VR design studio), says "An AR/VR project, like any other real time rendering project, has two sides: